Everything else about the Launch Pad is written to your family. This page is written to you.

Somebody probably handed you this. That is usually how it goes, and it is worth saying out loud that being handed something is not the same as wanting it. Nothing on this page is trying to talk you into anything.

What it actually is. Four mornings a week. Two with me in the room, two that are yours to run with nobody standing over you, and Friday, which is empty on purpose and stays empty. Six or seven people. Three years if you stay, and they turn as a cycle rather than a ladder, so whichever year is running when you arrive is the one you start in.

You keep a Captain's Log and nobody reads it. Not your family, not me. You also name one thing you love that never gets made useful here: never graded, never harvested, never turned into an assignment. Making time for it is the one thing genuinely required of you, and nobody will ever ask what you did with the time. Only whether the time was there.

What you can refuse. Six things are promised to you, and nothing here is allowed to break them. No grades or scores anyone but you can see. No ranking, ever. Nobody deposits answers into you. No imposed deadlines, and "I didn't get to it" is honored rather than punished. Your worth is not your output. No surveillance.

And one that sits on top of those six: **you may refuse the structure itself.** Decline a whole quest and you are fully honored, not quietly marked down. Your no is real, it costs you nothing, and nobody can overrule it.

Where your no stops, said now rather than when you are standing in it. Your no covers your own work. It does not cover how you treat the people in the room with you. That is the one place here where something can actually be taken from you, and the whole ladder is written down where you can read it.

If English is not your family's first language. We bring an interpreter and we pay for them. You will never be asked to translate this for your parents, not for any part of it. Someone your age translating *is this what you want?* to their own mother cannot answer it honestly, and we are not going to put you there.

What I will be paying attention to. Whether there is a question you cannot put down. Whether you have done something nobody made you do. Whether you can listen to someone else's story, and stand being listened to. What you do when nothing is required of you. I am not scoring any of it and there is no number anywhere.

What you should be paying attention to in me. Whether I answer the question you actually asked. Whether I can be told no, and what my face does when I am. Whether I say "I don't know" when I do not know. Whether what I say out loud matches what is written in the book. You are allowed to be checking. You should be.

Who this is not for, said plainly. If you want to know where you stand against other people, this will feel like being dropped, because that number does not exist here. If you want a big school with a lot of people and a lot of doors, this is six or seven of you in one room. If you need support I cannot give, there is one guide and no aide, and I would rather say so now and point you somewhere real than find out in November.

And if you are happy where you are: that is a complete answer. It is not a failure of nerve and nobody will think less of you for it.

Two things are not finished. The record you would take with you when you leave is still being built, and until it exists nobody walks the Launch. And a transcript from a studio like this is not yet something every college recognises; the bridge to dual enrollment is real work we would do alongside you rather than pretend is already done.

The book. Your family may have been told they can read every page of the teaching book. So can you. It is the same book. There is no hidden chapter and no page about managing a reluctant teenager, because it was written so that you could read it too.

You do not have to decide anything today.